

The logo for Slackware Linux, featuring the word "slackware" in a lowercase, sans-serif font, with "linux" in a smaller font below it. A horizontal line is positioned under the "slackware" text, and a small vertical line is positioned under the "l" in "linux".

slackware
linux

SLACKWARE: Simple, Straightforward and Stable

This article discusses Slackware, a free and open source Linux-based operating system.



Slackware GNU/Linux was created by Patrick Volkerding in 1993. It was originally a derivative of the 'Softlanding Linux System' (SLS), one of the most popular of the original GNU/Linux distributions and the first to offer a comprehensive software collection that comprised more than just the kernel and basic utilities.

In time, Slackware evolved into a separate system with clear goals and a development model, while its precursor, the SLS, lost the crowd's interest and soon vanished. Over the years, Slackware has had many versions and changes but it still remains the most loyal to its 'UNIX-like system' roots, among all the GNU/Linux distros.

The will to preserve and support a tech utility or way of

doing things well known to the user base is probably the best thing about Slackware. It makes you learn less unnecessary new stuff and keeps the user in control. This simplicity is not matched by any other system in existence.

Being a fairly new UNIX connoisseur, I was introduced to Slackware in its 14th avatar in the fall of 2012. I have missed the countless events and steps that Slackware has taken and the obstacles it has overcome over the years, to become the oldest still actively developed GNU/Linux distribution in existence. I missed the switch from 'X' to 'xfree86', and the project's lead developer Patrick Volkerding's mysterious illness back in the early 2000s.

Emotions apart, Slackware has a great tendency not to